



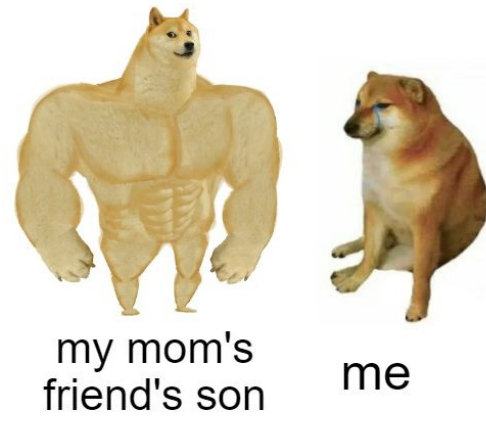
What PMs Actually Do



Aleksandra Fedorova, Evgeniia Fedotova, Zoia Kostyrev

What **our parents** think we do 🧑

- Just “organizing science projects”
- Sending out lots of emails and making people attend meetings
- Basically a glorified secretary



What **our friends** think we do 🧑

- Babysitting researchers with deadlines
- Writing Slack posts with memes
- Hosting endless Google Meet calls
- Writing announcements in the *Heroes of Might and Magic* format



What **product teams** think we do 🛒

- Magically delivering research results exactly when they are needed for production
- Fixing unclear communication and messy planning
- Providing “predictable predictability” out of chaos



What **division leads** think we do ➗

- Detecting risks before they become real problems
- Speeding up delivery across the whole division
- Keeping everyone satisfied while implementing smooth processes



What we actually do 🙌

Every day 🧐

🔧 Technical:

- Setting up an Agile board and configuring the ticket system to support the team’s workflow
- Managing Google/YouTrack accounts and access rights
- Organizing team document storage (YouTrack, Google Drive, GitHub)
- Transferring tickets between systems (GitHub → YouTrack or between YouTrack projects)
- Performing a health check of team processes
- Creating YouTrack workflows for automation
- Conducting retrospective meetings
- Creating/maintaining a team availability spreadsheet or a team’s Google Calendar
- Tracking and planning milestones
- Sharing updates and ensuring visibility

🎨 Creative:

- Communicating with stakeholders, composing update posts about the results of a project or an event
- Challenging ideas and tasks to assess whether they are truly needed for the project at the current stage
- Organizing team-building activities to strengthen connections within the team
- Calculating budgets
- Participating in creating OKRs
- Planning and facilitating brainstorming sessions
- Knowing everything (where the document is that we use during the meeting, how to make something in YouTrack, why my table looks weird, etc.)
- Sharing common / new knowledge or practices with everyone

Not every day 🧐

- Creating a process for collecting stakeholder feedback and calculating the overall satisfaction rate
- Developing onboarding / offboarding checklists for the department
- Improving the format of storing experiment run data to make it easier to read and reproduce
- Creating a department role matrix (RACI)
- Establishing a process for collecting and processing requests from product teams
- Defining a process for calculating the team’s velocity and time estimation correction factor
- Establishing a process of effective sharing and solving of problems
- Developing the pipeline for tracking interns
- Forcing YouTrack to work as we need
- Introducing new technologies and adapting them to people’s needs (e.g., Slack groups)

Here, either visualizations, or QR code, or call for action



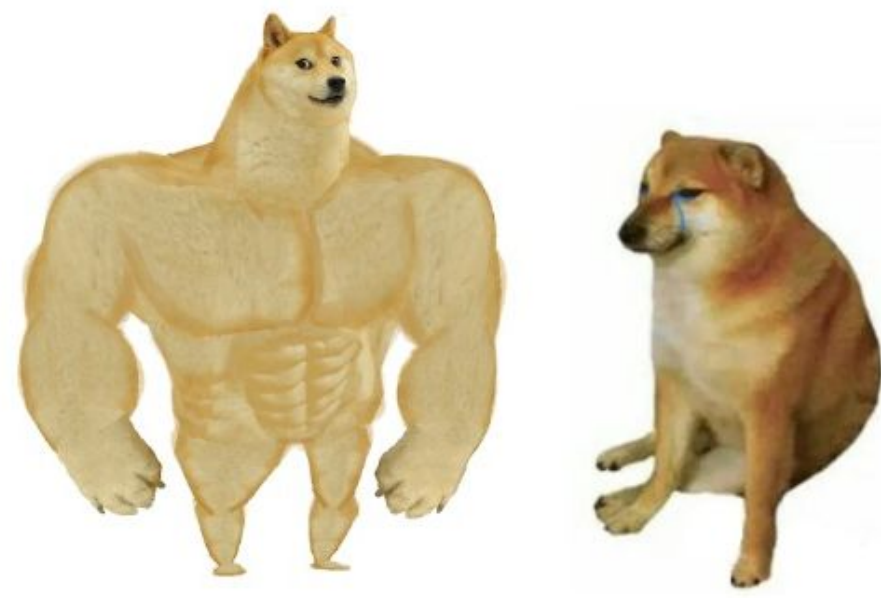
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my mom's friend's son

me

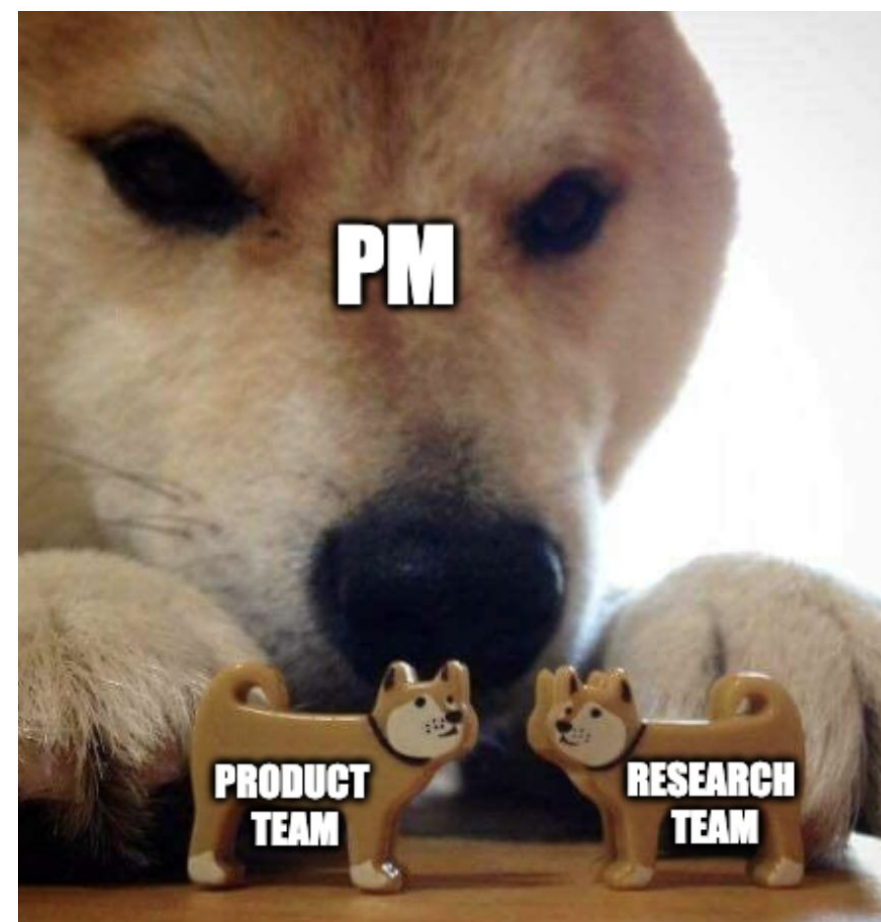
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What **product teams** think we do 🛒

- Magically delivering research results exactly when they are needed for production
- Forcing research teams satisfy all requests from stakeholders
- Providing “predictable predictability” out of chaos



What **research teams** think we do ➡

- Scheduling meetings about meetings so we never forget we have meetings
- Mastering the art of copy-pasting deadlines from calendar to Slack
- Forcing people to fill useless tables and docs



What we actually do 🙌

Every day 🧐

- Configure Agile board, ticket hierarchy, workflows
- Monitor and improve team processes (health checks, velocity tracking)
- Maintain team availability calendars and milestone plans
- Facilitate brainstorming, team-building, and retrospectives
- Share updates and ensure visibility
- Manage team accounts, access rights, and document storage
- Communicate with stakeholders
- Participate in budgeting and OKRs creation
- Challenge ideas and estimations to ensure relevance and value
- Know everything (what/ where/ who/ how?)



Not every day 🧐

- YT magic hacks
- Build department-level tools
 - Role matrix
 - Internship pipeline
 - Onboarding/offboarding checklists
 - Feedback collection and satisfaction tracking
- Introduce/adapt new tools and technologies
- Organize Team building activities
- You need something? We'll make a process for it!
 - Collect and processing product teams requests
 - Calculate the team's velocity and time estimation correction factor
 - Improve data storage for easier reproducibility



Learn more about our processes